

Concept Ideation

My Concept Idea on "How Might We encourage more students to attend in-person Office Hours to get help because students getting in-person help is more effective and reduces stress"

2026

April 2nd

AGENDA	HOW MIGHT WE (HMW) STATEMENT	3
	SCAMPER	4-5
	BRAINSTORMING SET-UP	6
	BRAINSTORMING PROCESS & IDEAS	7
	6 TOP IDEAS	8
	THE END	9

HOW MIGHT WE (HMW) STATEMENT

1. How Might We encourage students to go to Office Hours without feeling concerned or scared?
 - a. How Might We help students communicate with Profs/TAs because
2. How Might We encourage TAs/Professors to display a positive attitude and environment for all students?
3. How Might We change the communications between students and TAs/Professors
4. How Might We pursue students to use Office Hours as an advantage on getting the help they need before their stress increases?
 - a. How Might We encourage students to go in-person OHs to get help because students getting one-on-one help is more effective.
 - b. How Might We encourage more students to attend in-person Office Hours to get help because students getting in-person help is more effective and reduces stress.
5. How Might We use professional and constructive feedback or words of encouragement towards students [put yourself in the shoes of a professor/TA]?
6. How Might We avoid using unprofessional and deconstructive feedback or words towards students when they are asking "dumb" questions, the student performed poorly, and/or the class performed badly?
7. How Might We create a solution where students don't socially embarrass other students for asking "stupid" questions?
8. How Might We influence profs/TAs to host more Office Hours so it can accommodate all students (CSE, CLA, CFANS) + classes that don't have OHs like DESI 2701 or PDES 2702 or CDES?
9. How Might We create an extension that can help with communications via email or any other social media platform that can make both parties aware of the situation? (UX Experience)
10. How Might We encourage students to not give up on the class or major when they are struggling as TAs or Professors?

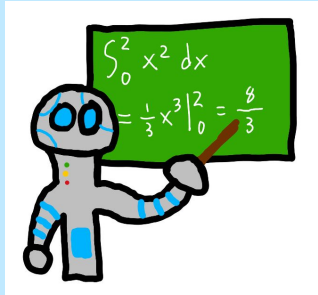
FINAL:

How Might We encourage more students to attend in-person Office Hours to get help because students getting in-person help is more effective and reduces stress.

SCAMPER (1-5)

IDEA 1

ROBO-TA



A robot that is a TA that is programmed like ROZ from *The Wild Robot* - a kind, empathetic, and optimistic robot. The robot will not judge what questions you ask and will help you with any topic you are studying

IDEA 2

MR. TAI



Mr. TAI is an app/website that will not just help students with academics but also encourage students to continue pursuing their dream major even though it is difficult

IDEA 3

ELECTRO OFFICE HOURS

OFFICE HOURS				
CLASS	TIME	LOCATION	PERSON	STATUS
EE 2361	9:00	KELLER 2-192	WZ	MOVED TO TH
EE 2361	1:30	KELLER 2-276	705H	IN 3 HOURS
EE 2361	2:00	KELLER 2-276	WENYU	IN 3 5 HOURS
CSC1 450W	11:30	KELLER 1-201	JAMES	NOW
CSC1 450W	1:30	LIND L-103	NO	CANCELLED

An electric board that would display the schedule for Office Hours for all classes along with updates on if office hours have been moved or cancelled. This is similar to Flight Information Display Systems. This should also hopefully encourage students going to office hours as well

IDEA 4

GOLDY VERTISEMENT



Goldy Gopher, the mascot for UMN, advertises Office Hours to students by holding and flipping a sign so student can be persuaded to go in a fun way and then can get the help they need.

IDEA 5

"OFFICE HOURS" BUTTON



A button that would say "GO TO OFFICE HOURS!" when you press it. It is supposed to motivate students in going to Office Hours

SCAMPER (6-10)

IDEA 6

FLYER IN THE AIR



A flyer that is attached to the back of an airplane is. This is easily spread the word around campus to students to go to Office Hours. The inspiration behind this is from Impractical Jokers.

IDEA 7

UMN 1001



UMN 1001 is similar to classes like CSE 1001, EE 1001 that would introduce students to the department, multiple majors you can take, and Office Hours and why it is effective to your academic success and reduces stress. UMN 1001 would have all majors and departments all together

IDEA 8

GOLDY'S OFFICE HOURS



Instead of TAs or Professors running the office hours, it would be Goldy Gopher that is running it. It will be a fun experience for all students

IDEA 9

OFFICE HOURS FRATERNITY



An academic fraternity that will have members to host Office Hours from all class categories and will encourage students to get the help that they need. This will not be a social fraternity that throws a party 24/7
365

IDEA 10

TREE FLYERS



A tree that grows flyers about Office Hours and there are specific trees will grow out leaves with text saying "GO TO OFFICE HOURS" or "NZ's Office Hours is starting in 1 hour in Keller 2-276 for EE 2361"

BRAINSTORMING SET-UP

Brainstorming



Participants



Rose:

- Sophomore
- Studying Product Design

Makenzie:

- Freshman
- Studying UX Experience

Maryam:

- Freshman
- Studying UX Experience
- Attends Office Hours

Ingrid:

- Sophomore
- Studying Mechanical Engineering and Product Design
- Attends Office Hours

Nef:

- Junior
- Studying Mechanical Engineering and Product Design
- Attends Office Hours

Location: McNeal Hall
Time: After DESI 2701 class
(around 6:30pm) on 3/26



Planned time: 1hr, Actual time: 30 mins

- Games: Skip
- Explain: 5 mins
- Brainstorm: 20 mins
- Sort: 5 mins
- Voting: Skip

Note: Since I was the last person to do my BSU, everyone was exhausted and we didn't get to do everything, hence why it was shorter than the planned time. But I will say that I am grateful for my participants staying and pushing through my brainstorm time

BRAINSTORMING PROCESS & IDEAS

Best Idea and Stats

Stats:

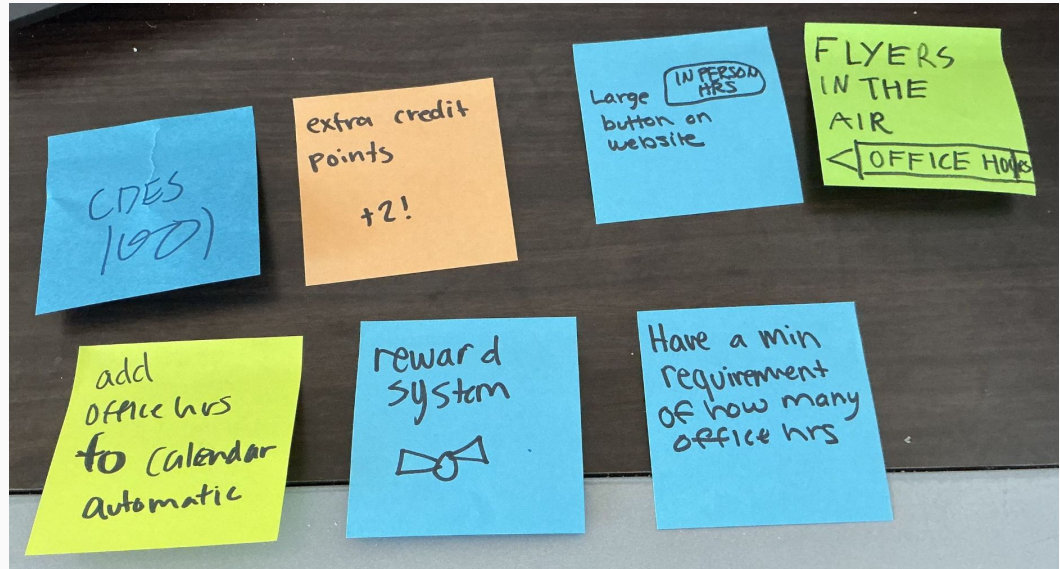
We got to 42 post it notes. Most of them are class related.

Number of Ideas for all 5 categories:

- TA: 15 ideas
- Classes: 14 ideas
- Advocating: 4 ideas
- Advertising: 2 ideas
- Tech: 7 ideas

TA has the most ideas

Best Ideas



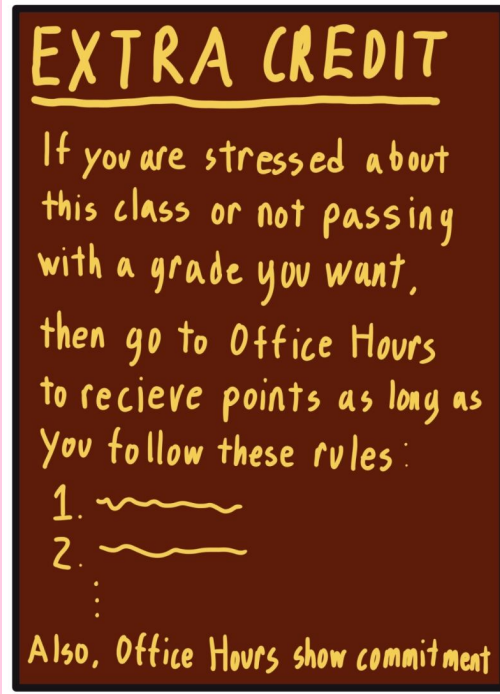
TOP 6 IDEAS: IDEA 1 - EXTRA CREDIT OFFICE HOURS

Description:

An academic motivation to get students to go to Office Hours (OHs) to boost their grades up while getting the help they need to reduce their stress on hard assignments. In order to earn the extra credit, students need to show up and ask questions about assignments, exams, and topics related to the course.

Why it's novel:

- Encourages students to go to OHs in a meaningful way
 - Getting the help they need
 - Reduces the stress on assignments, exams, and grade for the class
- Shows that the student is trying to pass the class with care and without the TAs or professor worrying about students cheating or not caring



TOP 6 IDEAS: IDEA 2 - REWARD OFFICE HOURS

Description:

A chrome extension that tracks the number of times you go to office hours and it will rack up points. Students can use those points to earn rewards like cookies, AirPods, iPads, Desktops, notebooks, or any other academic item.

However, in order to earn points, students must work on assignments or over topics. They can't go to office hours and just socialize with the TA.

Why it's novel:

- It motivates students to attend Office Hours (OHs)
- Students can earn something good and it would save them money as well.
- This is an extension I can see still being used for a long time after generation after generation



TOP 6 IDEAS: IDEA 3 - FLYERS IN THE AIR

Description:

An plane would be flying in the sky with a long flyer saying "GO TO OFFICE HOURS IF YOU WANT NO STRESS". It can also have Skydivers do this too. It is similar to the skydivers performing at the first UMN football game of the season

Why it's novel:

- While the idea is not fully original, this advertisement strategy solely focuses on UMN
- Students can see the flyer from all locations on the
- Entertains students to go to Office Hours in a fun



TOP 6 IDEAS: IDEA 4 - UMN 1001

Description:

A University of Minnesota class that is required for freshman students to take about it would have all students from all different departments and majors to learn about how to have a successful college experience and will teach students about Office Hours and why it is effective to your academic success and reduces stress. Students can take this class in any semester when they start their college journey.

Why it's novel:

- Although this is similar to CSE 1001 and EE 1001, this will be offer for all semesters because everyone starts their college journey differently
- Students in CDES and CSOM can learn what Office Hours (OHs) is since (from my experience) would take classes that don't have OHs.
 - This can also help students to learn that it's okay to ask for help and have 1-on-1 OHs with a TA or professor
- This can help students connecting with other students from all majors



TOP 6 IDEAS: IDEA 5 - ELECTRO OFFICE HOURS

Description:

An electric board that would display the schedule for Office Hours (OHs) for all classes where it is located along with updates on if office hours have been moved or cancelled. This is similar to Flight Information Display Systems. This should also hopefully encourage students going to OHs as well since there will be motivational text saying "PLEASE GO TO OFFICE HOURS! IT REDUCES STRESS AND WILL HELP YOU SUCCEED".

Why it's novel:

- Displays the schedule of all OHs for each class
- Easier to follow and find what TA or professor students want to go for OHs for their classes
- With or without the motivational text, it gives a clear picture about the importance of OHs

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EE 2361	9:00	KELLER 2-192	NZ	MOVED TO TH
EE 2361	1:30	KELLER 2-276	TOSH	IN 3 HOURS
EE 2361	2:00	KELLER 2-276	WENYU	IN 3.5 HOURS
CSCI 4511W	11:30	KELLER 1-201	JAMES	NOW
CSCI 4511W	1:30	LIND L-103	MO	CANCELLED

PLEASE GO TO OFFICE HOURS! IT REDU

11:26AM
1 APRIL 2026

TOP 6 IDEAS: IDEA 6 - OFFICE HOURS FRATERNITY

Description:

An academic fraternity that will have members to host Office Hours from all class categories and will encourage students to get the help that they need. This will not be a social fraternity that throws a party 24/7 365, but when students do successful and consistently show growth and commitment, a non-alcoholic party can be thrown.

Why it's novel:

- The majority of the fraternities at UMN are social fraternities. This one focuses on academics
- Easier access to get help
- Positive environment
- Introduce students to fraternities in a friendlier way
- Welcomes all majors so everyone can get the help they need. It is not just for a specific department



Thank you!

Remember to go to Office Hours! It will help you, save your time, and reduce your stress on school!

Contact
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LinkedIn: NZ Gorham